

Nearly 1,400 Workers Laid Off at Ohio Truck Factory

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Nearly 1,400 people lost their jobs at what had been the Navistar truck factory in Springfield, Ohio. The **layoffs** happened on Wednesday, three days before President Donald Trump's planned **rally** at a nearby high school. A **layoff** means a worker loses a job because an employer cuts jobs.

The job losses were roughly equal to a whole year of job growth in the greater Dayton area. Kyle Bos was one of the workers. He has two daughters, with a third due in January. He said rising grocery prices were also making life harder for his family.

Bos belongs to the United Auto Workers **union**. He said he had voted for Trump three times. Now he plans to help Democrats win votes before the November election. He said the **layoffs** were one reason for that change.

The Dayton area has lost about half of its 90,000 factory jobs since 1990, according to federal data. In recent years, its economy has improved as Wright-Patterson Air Force Base expanded. The base directly employs 38,000 people. Its innovations have also attracted aircraft companies to the area.

Trump said **manufacturing** was coming back. The White House pointed to an \$850 million **investment** by aircraft maker Electra as evidence that his policies were creating jobs.

Jeff Hoagland, CEO of the Dayton Development Coalition, said both Republicans and Democrats had recognized the base's value. He explained that developing an economy takes time.

Word Treasure

layoff -- The loss of a job because an employer cuts jobs.

rally -- A gathering where people hear a speaker or support a cause.

union -- A group of workers who join together to represent their interests.

manufacturing -- Making products, often in factories.

investment -- Money put into a business or project to help it develop.

Background you need

A layoff happens when an employer cuts jobs.

The article describes both factory job losses and growth linked to an air force base.

Break it down

Opens with the factory layoffs and their timing.

Describes one worker's family concerns and political plans.

Explains the area's job losses and more recent growth.

Ends with attributed views about jobs and economic development.

Why it matters

Job losses affect families' income and can influence what voters want from elected leaders.

Test what you remember

1. Where was the truck factory that laid off workers?
 - (A) Springfield, Ohio
 - (B) A city in January
 - (C) A city in Texas
 - (D) Dayton, Ohio
2. How many people lost their jobs at the factory?
 - (A) Nearly 850 people
 - (B) About 90,000 people
 - (C) Nearly 1,400 people
 - (D) About 38,000 people
3. What did Bos say was also making family life harder?
 - (A) Fewer bus services
 - (B) Rising grocery prices
 - (C) Longer school days
 - (D) Higher library fees
4. What does Bos now plan to do before the election?
 - (A) Help Republicans win votes
 - (B) Help Electra build planes
 - (C) Help Democrats win votes
 - (D) Help the base hire workers
5. What expanded as the local economy improved?
 - (A) The United Auto Workers union
 - (B) The former Navistar factory
 - (C) Wright-Patterson Air Force Base
 - (D) The nearby high school
6. What did Jeff Hoagland explain?
 - (A) Developing an economy takes time
 - (B) Planning a rally takes time
 - (C) Building a truck takes time
 - (D) Counting election votes takes time

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: B 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Kyle Bos:** He said rising grocery prices were making family life harder and the layoffs helped change his political plans.
2. **Donald Trump:** He said manufacturing was coming back.
3. **Jeff Hoagland:** He said both parties had recognized the base's value and economic development takes time.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):